

Apple's Swift 3.1 to improve the programming experience on Linux

Apple has announced the next version of its open source programming language, Swift 3.1, which will include some hidden but worthy improvements to the Linux platform.

The Swift programming language has already been a breakthrough introduction for developers as well as a fruitful move by Apple to reach out to the open source community. But to influence Linux users, its upcoming version will include certain positive tweaks. Apple is also considering the source compatibility with Swift 3.0 as the top priority for developers.



"It is a strong goal that the vast majority of sources that built with the Swift 3.0 compiler continue to build with the Swift 3.1 compiler. The exception will be bug fixes to the compiler that cause it to reject code that should never have been accepted in the first place," said Ted Kremenek, senior manager for languages and runtimes, Apple, in a blog post.

In addition to the improvements on Linux, Apple has improved the Swift package manager, compiler and standard library within Swift 3.1. There are also quite a few major additions to upgrade the development experience.

Apple has not yet declared any definite release schedule. However, the next Swift update is expected to be rolled out some time between March to June in 2017. The Cupertino giant is planning to deploy considerable efforts for Swift 4.0 that will be out a few months after the Swift 3.1 release.

to merge its software business with SUSE's parent company Micro Focus, in order to concentrate on next-generation hybrid cloud solutions.

"We are evolving our investment strategy to focus on developing the next generation of hybrid cloud solutions, which combines HPE technology with a broad ecosystem of open source and partner technologies that support traditional and cloud-native applications," said Ric Lewis, senior vice president and general manager of the software-defined and cloud group, HPE.

"SUSE's acquisition of HPE talent and technology assets would add more muscle to the OpenStack Cloud by SUSE," Kalyan Muppaneni, founder and CEO, Pi Datacenters, told *Open Source For You*. "We believe that this will help enhance SUSE OpenStack's capabilities and deliver even more superior enterprise cloud solutions to our customers," he added.

This major step taken by HPE does not mean that the enterprise-centric company is leaving the field of PaaS and Infrastructure-as-a-Service (IaaS) or exiting the OpenStack and Cloud Foundry market. In fact, HPE is apparently aiming to improve its Helion OpenStack and Stackato solutions through SUSE's experience. "By partnering with SUSE, HPE will continue to provide high-quality OpenStack and Cloud Foundry PaaS solutions that are simple to deploy into customer's multi-cloud environments," stated Lewis.

In September 2016, HPE had announced that SUSE was going to be its preferred Linux partner. That development was made public in the midst of the merger between Micro Focus and HPE's software business segment.

Market analysts believe that the fresh deal is a 'real win-win' for SUSE and HPE and their clients worldwide. "This expanded partnership and transfer of technology assets have the potential to be a real win-win for SUSE and HPE, as well as customers of both companies," said Ashish Nadkarni, programme director — computing platforms, IDC.

Qualcomm develops 10nm server processor with Linux support

Qualcomm has initiated what it claims is the next level of data centre computing with the launch of its Centriq 2400 series. This new chip is supposedly the world's first 10-nanometre server processor and supports the Linux platform out-of-the-box.

San Diego-based Qualcomm has designed its Centriq family 'to reshape the future' of data centres. As the first in the advanced line-up, the Qualcomm Centriq 2400 series comes with the 10nm FinFET process technology. It also includes a Falkor CPU and a custom ARMv8-compliant core to enhance performance along with a major reduction in power consumption.

"The Qualcomm Centriq 2400 series processors will drive high performance, power-efficient ARM-based servers from concept to reality," said

